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BOOK REVIEWS

SVEN RUNE HAVSTEEN, NILS HOLGER PETERSEN, HEINRICH W. SCHWAB, and EYOLF ØSTREM, eds.: *Creations: Medieval Rituals, the Arts, and the Concept of Creation*. Turnhout: Brepols, 2007; pp. x + 269.

Growing out of a 2003 conference on “The Cultural Heritage of Medieval Rituals II: Creation and the Arts,” this edited collection of essays explores the relationships between the theological act of Creation of the world by God, and the human endeavour of artistic creation. Spanning from the medieval to the modern era, the volume works across the early modern rupture in order to explore the transformation of the conception of creation. With topics ranging from medieval liturgy, through baroque art, and up to the music of Schoenberg, the editors have brought together subjects touching upon the theme of creation that span a millennia in order to excavate the medieval theological roots of modern discourses of the creative act. The essays in this volume argue that the “theological idea of divine creation of something totally, unprecedentedly new — *ex nihilo* — was only gradually applied to human creativity in connection with the emergence of a modern conception of art” (p. 4). The figure of the modern artist represents a radical shift not because it is, in itself, a new creation, but because it constituted the usurpation of an act previously exclusively within the ambit of divine praxis, as the introductory remarks reflecting on the second commandment remind the reader. Further developing the idea of the medieval genealogy of contemporary understandings of artistic creation, the volume argues that with post-modernity we have come full circle, as artistic practice returns to acts of reordering, restructuring, and reusing. The project of locating the cultural heritage of modern discourses of artistic creation in the Middle Ages is provocative, and the individual essays collected in the volume trace out the contours of this transdiscursive historiography, describing the relationship between medieval theology and ritual that have shaped Western notions of artistic creation from Jesuit representations of creation, through to the music of Mahler and Schoenberg. Østrem’s essay acts as an entry point into the volume by unpacking the parallel discourses of the *Deus artifex* and *homo creator* as they were written and reworked through classical writing, medieval scholastic thought, and into the sixteenth century. Østrem writes across the great divide between “the theocentric Middle Ages and the anthropocentric art world of the modern age” (p. 16) while reminding the reader to avoid tracing out a linear shift from one paradigm to the other as a straightforward teleological narrative. The volume continues in this vein, drawing on a wide range of interdisciplinary methods in order to map out the interconnections between medieval and modern understandings of creation that have previously been conceptualized purely in terms of rupture and disjuncture. With essays ranging widely in subject, disciplinary framework, and historical periods, the volume would have benefitted from enlarged commentary from the editors in order to give the reader a greater sense of the unity of the project.

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VALÉRIE LECLERC-LAFAGE: *Montpellier au temps des troubles de religion. Pratiques testamentaires et confessionnalisation (1554–1622)*. Paris: Champion (La Vie des Huguenots, 52), 2010; pp. 512.

Valerie Leclerc-Lafage's book is based on her 2004 doctoral thesis (University of Bordeaux III). A general introduction explains the genesis of the research, undertaken from 1999, and her initial chapter defines the methodological problems associated with the use of early-modern Montpellier wills. The author creates a useful overview of the historiography of notarial function for one turbulent century in the city's history, covering the whole of the Wars of Religion as they touched the region. In particular, due weight is given to the work of Michel Vovelle and Pierre Chaunu, before noting the decline in use of their sources since the 1990s (p. 37). In this manner, the study situates itself as running against current trends in early-modern French historiography. But Leclerc-Lafage defends her methodology by championing its ability to better display "the phenomena of confessionnalisation" (p. 38). She cites in her defence the work of German scholars Wolfgang Reinhard, Ernst Walter Zeeden, and Heinz Schilling. Leclerc-Lafage has processed the data from many wills (chapter 2, p. 90), supported by an assortment of scattered sources (pp. 109–114). She adopts a survey method, comprehending 2,243 wills. The analysis is based primarily on 1,556 of them with specific concentration on the years 1554–1622 (pp. 99–100).

The second part of the work presents "the world of the testators." A table analyzing the socio-professional distribution of the will-makers attempts to give context. Perhaps unsurprisingly for a Protestant community, craftsmen constitute the major category. The poor are absent and clergy are oddly underrepresented. The majority of the testators are male with the Catholics a distinct minority (36% compared to 53% Protestants and 11% indeterminate, p. 143). The population wavered, however, and between 1602 and 1617, 406 notarial documents show 46% Catholic versus 49% Reformed (p. 152). In 1622, the city was besieged by royal troops, causing 840 wills to be made: Calvinists represented 69%. Here is part of the methodological problem as Leclerc-Lafage cannot determine the politics of confessional self-description; for example, on 16 July 1622 a brother organized his burial "in the apostolic Roman Catholic religion," while his brother declared himself to be of the "reformed religion" (p. 159).

Leclerc-Lafage pursues an effective and interesting examination of subtler cultural contexts in Montpellier. Old Testament first names were generally reserved for the first-born child alone (p. 173). Similarly, she shows a strange variation existed in Montpellier: while in Paris, Pierre Chaunu showed most Huguenot wills contained an "invocation to God," a specifically Protestant prayer, 10% of Montpellier wills lack them (p. 232). The invocation remains in the majority of wills, but its form varies from one will to the next, emphasizing Jesus Christ at God's side (p. 244), in opposition to the Catholic inclusion of the Virgin Mary and saints in a short and general formula while most testators requested the remission of the sins and entry to paradise. Appropriately, Huguenot testators rarely gave directions for their funeral (p. 339), reflecting the value of this archive-based case study in supporting assertions made generally about the Huguenot worldview; see Bernard Roussel, "'Ensevelir honnestement les corps': funeral corteges and Huguenot culture," in *Society and Culture in the Huguenot World, 1559–1685*, edited by Raymond A. Mentzer and Andrew Spicer (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2002), 193–208.

The study underlines the fluid border between Catholic and Protestant in Montpellier (i.e., the Reformed remained bound to some traditional local practices, while Catholics renounced certain funerary rites, p. 352). The final chapter addresses the central Catholic concern for masses, reflected in 212 of the 639 Catholic wills surveyed. These

requests cover the entire period (p. 356), allowing Leclerc-Lafage to argue, in combination with other evidence, for the absence of a deep division between Protestants and Catholics before the full effects of the Counter-Reformation took hold in the mid-seventeenth century. On this point of religious coexistence rests the central importance of this book, along with its valuable collection of data for the history of confessionalization strongly in accord with work such as that done by Philip Benedict and others; see Philip Benedict, "Confessionalization in France? Critical Reflections and New Evidence," in *Society and Culture in the Huguenot World, 1559–1685*, edited by R. A. Mentzer and Andrew Spicer (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2002), 44–61.

Leclerc-Lafage's work is well supported by an index and appendices. Of great use is a series of biographical notes on Montpellier's notaries from 1514 to 1633 (pp. 463–6).

MATTHEW GLOZIER
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MIA M. MOCHIZUKI: *The Netherlandish Image after Iconoclasm, 1566–1672: Material Religion in the Dutch Golden Age*. Aldershot, UK: Ashgate, 2008; pp. xxiv + 399.

The Protestant Reformation(s) and iconoclasm have received enormous scholarly attention, much of it concerned with motivation, intent, and implementation of physical and mental change. Mochizuki's book fits firmly into the last category, taking as its case study the effect of Reformed control and use of Haarlem's Great Church, formerly known to Catholics as St Bavo's Cathedral.

This glossy book contains many fine colour pictures of church interiors and paintings contemporary with the events described. It does a good job of demonstrating the alteration of church interiors and at illustrating the meaning of that change based on evolving theological prejudices through an in-depth analysis of Haarlem's chief place of worship.

Mochizuki's method is to describe in detail the physical environment of pre- and post-Reformation Dutch churches, then to examine in depth the changes created for Dutch Reformed services in the altered Great Church. She is most effective when describing the significance of altar panels and the replacement of Catholic images with Protestant text in the Calvinist privileging of The Word: the central Reformed concept of simplicity and directness in worship over the perceived distraction of images. Though historically competent, Mochizuki situates this narrative of word-over-image within a conceptual framework designed to move beyond categories of function or style into deeper theological, social, and psychological insights. Unfortunately, this has the effect of obscuring contemporary historical realities: most glaringly the connection between Reformed church and state, best represented by the replacement of Catholic religious images by civic and personal heraldic devices and the representation of secular imagery for groups such as the trades' guilds. For example, this leads Mochizuki to express surprise that armorial stained glass allowed, as if by stealth, an echo of the colour from pre-reformed days.

The study begins with the misplaced assumption that iconoclasm resulted in a kind of white-washed vacuum, where previously there had existed the riotous colours of Catholic devotional images and statuary. Having introduced her topic thus, Mochizuki is puzzled at the survival in Netherlandish churches of some pre-Reformation religious art and the creation of much new colourful post-Reformation decoration. She describes in detail the meaning of specifically Protestant replacements of pulpits,

organs, and choir screens and lays greatest weight on the creation of text panels where Catholic altarpieces once stood; see C. A. van Swigchem, T. Brouwer and W. van Os, *Een huis voor het Woord, Het Protestantse kerkinterieur in Nederland tot 1900* (The Hague and Zeist: Staatsuitgeverij and Rijksdienst voor de Monumentenzorg, 1984); and J. D. Bangs, *Church Art and Architecture in the Low Countries before 1566* (Kirkville: Sixteenth Century Journal Publishers, 1997).

Chapter one describes the pre-Reformation church, its devotional programme through the role of priests, the function of altarpieces, sculptures, statues of apostles, and their representation of the Catholic creed. Here she enunciates the role of art in stimulating Catholic piety.

Chapter two discusses what was removed (carefully supervised, not wantonly destroyed) and enumerates the creation of a new religious outlook, using among other evidence Abraham ben Jacob's *Abraham and the Idols* (1695) to expand on the Reformed attitude towards images in the church. She makes well-warranted comparisons between iconoclasts then and now, discussing the Taliban militia's destruction of Buddhist statues in Afghanistan. This point might have been expanded profitably, but Mochizuki refuses to wrestle with the central Reformed objection to "idoltrous" images, preferring to discuss art of all sorts within the church. This runs the risk of losing sight of the centrality of Calvinist aversion to "idols" as a motivation and explanation of the very artistic survivals within Netherlandish churches that she claims to be explaining.

Chapter three ("The Word Made Material") examines the physical substance of church fabric from bricks-and-mortar to wood and paint. Chapters four ("The Word Made Memorial") and five ("The Word Made Manifest") discuss the Word on boards and the pulpit within a broader philosophical/spatial consideration. She has some good and effective points to make about the use of the church within the broader community and touches on issues of civic involvement and church elders, giving in English some of the conclusions reached in *Een Huis voor het Woord* by van Swigchem, Brouwer, and van Os. Her prose is opaque on occasion with some convoluted word choice and expression; for example, "How did a seven-stanza panegyric coagulate to form a picture of loss?" (p. 193). Her point is well taken that the Reformation caused paint and wood (and to a lesser extent stone) to be employed in the creation of specifically non-Catholic art based on clearly reasoned choices.

Mochizuki mentions Reformed insistence on biblical prohibitions of divine images, but she refuses to accept that saints' statues may have been worshiped as idols (254), nor does she discuss Protestant disgust at practices including indulgence prayers purchased to be said before these images. This is the central weakness of her thesis: she treats all art within the church as equal. Though she lays due weight on Protestant innovations such as the text board, she must tie herself in argumentative knots in order to reconcile the survival of some art, while other objects were destroyed. Occasionally, she employs anachronism to aid her thesis; for example, using van Bree's *Mayor of Leiden* (1816–1817) (p. 204) to illustrate a point about the use of Haarlem's armorial insignia within the church. She makes good points about Huguenot influence on Dutch Protestantism, but there appears to be room for a deeper integration of French Calvinists into her discussion (e.g., the influence of architect de l'Orme, pp. 64–65; the Charenton *temple*, p. 138), especially given the weight she lays on Calvin himself who was, after all, the central figure in a highly international Protestant community.

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JOHN W. O'MALLEY: *What Happened at Vatican II*. Cambridge, MA, and London: Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 2008; pp. xi + 389. Illus.

As the author of this volume acknowledges, there has proved to be a vast amount of literature produced on the subject of the Vatican II Council since its staging between 1962 and 1965. An additional work on its significance and repercussions needs a fair amount of justification, not least of all by providing new insights. In *What Happened at Vatican II*, John O'Malley largely achieves this through a fascinating and well-written account based upon meticulous research and detailed historical analysis. As a priest, academic, and first-hand observer he clearly has the credentials to pen this volume, but it is enhanced by a profound grasp of the impact of the Council in forging a place for the Roman Catholic Church in the modern world, while retaining its distinctiveness. This was no easy task for the Church and, as O'Malley points out, one of the remarkable facts about Vatican II was its duration through four lengthy sessions that lasted nearly four years — far longer than initially planned and which may well have lasted considerably longer if it were not for financial restraints.

The first part of the volume provides a lengthy contextual underpinning vital to understanding a hallmark event in Catholic history that Vatican II clearly constituted and how it came about when it did. There are some illuminating facts and figures here related to its sheer magnitude and scope, alongside a number of astute observations related to its truly international dimension. As O'Malley observes, the Roman Church faced a number of pressing issues, some so pressing that if they were not addressed, then it faced serious decline in a world that threw up so many challenges to its authority and legitimacy. Some of these challenges the Church had encountered since the Enlightenment but they had become far more acute in the wake of the European revolutions of the nineteenth century and, in the twentieth century, the challenge of Communism, the secular society, the separation of Church and State in Catholic heartlands, and nuclear weapon proliferation. There were more perennial problems too, including the authority of the Church, the priesthood, attitudes towards the Jews, Christian ecumenism, advances of science, not to mention a host of theological matters.

O'Malley structures the volume through an account of the four annual sessions which dealt with the vast array of topics explored by Vatican II. There were those related to the internal workings of the Church itself. This included the pressing matters of the sacred liturgy and the sources of revelation. Both pointed towards polarized views which were the basis of some acrimony, consequently raising questions regarding sources of authority in the Church. The former centred on the Mass and its conduction in the vernacular which in a sense came eventually about not by deliberation but by developing greater lay participation. Some of these issues touched upon those left open by the council of Trent (1545–1563) that had responded to the Protestant Reformation, in particular, the role of scripture and tradition, which proved difficult due to the perennial problem in separating the two. Also debated were the burning topics of the charismatic gifts of the Spirit, the cult of Mary, and religious conscience. The latter extended into the area of Christian ecumenism and the legitimacy of non-Christian faiths. Ecumenism was to have deep implications and symbolized by the new Pope, Paul VI (John XXIII who convened Vatican II died in 1963), who became first pontiff to leave Italy for five centuries in an international tour conducted during the final session of the Council and which included a meeting with leading Orthodox patriarchs. Other issues, commencing in earnest in the second period of 1963, included debates on the presence of the Church in the modern world: global peace, its policy towards underdeveloped nations, migrants, and human rights.

The great insight provided by this volume is that, from the onset, two groups, relatively small, emerged from thousands of bishops, and that the rest of the bishops would have to judge between the two sides, not only on many of the above issues but also on the general orientation of the Council. The triumphant progressive faction was comprised by those most aware of theological and philosophical developments and who could apply them to a changing world, but with a certain historical continuity. At the same time, particular matters were kept off of the agenda: priestly celibacy, birth control, reform of the Curia, and the mechanism to implement collegiality at the centre of the Church. Clearly, O' Malley offers a sympathetic account of what came out of Vatican II but with a discerning eye and not without a tinge of ironic commentary. Here is an exploration of how the Church is consistently able to sustain an organic evolution, to do what it has always done so well: to reconcile contradictions, and to adapt and consolidate — the enduring method of its survival.

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CAROLE CUSACK: *Invented Religions*. Farnham, Surrey: Ashgate, 2010; pp. viii + 179.

Carole M. Cusack's new book, *Invented Religions*, is an impressive work that explores the development and context of a number of extant invented religions. Focusing upon Discordianism, the Church of All Worlds, the Church of the SubGenius, Jediism, Matrixism, and the Church of the Flying Spaghetti Monster, Cusack makes the case that religions exist in dialogue with the broader culture of which they are a part. These particular groups are considered within their broader cultural context, and Cusack argues convincingly for their interpretation as genuinely, if perhaps unusually, religious. Unsurprisingly, the text focuses upon the invented nature of these beliefs, most particularly highlighting the explicit nature of their fictionality, as opposed to other, less overt, instances of religious invention.

With the exception of the first chapter, which articulates the broader context of the groups in question, the bulk of the text is taken up with descriptive overviews of the various groups. Discordianism, the Church of All Worlds, and the Church of the SubGenius are all addressed in some detail, while the other groups share a chapter between them. Cusack's initial contextualization provides an introductory orientation to the field, touching on issues of secularization, individualism, consumption, narrative, imagination, humour, and spiritual exploration, amongst others.

Chapter 2 is given over to the discussion of Discordianism. Originating in the late 1950s, Discordianism has maintained appeal for over 50 years, and has itself inspired a number of other fictionally oriented and humorous spiritualities. Founded by Kerry Wendell and Greg Hill, Discordianism is a unique blend of popular culture, ancient myth, conspiracy theories, and American-style Buddhism within the context of DIY culture and an orientation towards a particularly anarchistic type of free thought. The chapter explores these issues in some depth, discussing both the history of the group and highlighting exemplary elements of the metaphysic.

The next chapter is oriented on the development and philosophy of the Church of All Worlds. Highlighting the relevance of Heinlein's *A Stranger in a Strange Land* in its formation, the analytical emphasis in this chapter is placed upon the more explicitly pagan elements of the belief. Environmental themes, Goddess theology, polygamy, and magical practices are all explored, as are some of the many publications related to the

group. Similarly to Discordianism, the Church of All Worlds has maintained itself over a number of decades, and has proved to be persistent, if somewhat numerically limited. In this context, the emphasis is placed upon the particular importance of Heinlein's text, irrespective of authorial intention, in the creation and continued appeal of the religion.

The Church of the SubGenius provides a more recent example of the religious utilization of late modern American popular cultural and countercultural ideas, emerging in the late 1970s. Cusack focuses upon articulating central elements of the specific mythology, such as Bob Dobbs and "slack," as well as exploring the relevance of broader ideas such as culture jamming and ontological anarchy. Lovecraft, L. Ron Hubbard, the Bavarian Illuminati, and yetis are some of the many popular themes addressed in this context.

The final chapter of the text goes on to explore emergent religiosity through the instances of Jediism, Matrixism, and the Church of the Flying Spaghetti Monster. These groups represent the most recent iteration of invented religion, grouped together as exemplary instances of third-millennium invented religions. Science fiction and its modern development is a significant theme, as is the Internet as the primary locale for these groups. Particular issues such as the 2001 census in relation to Jediism, the messianic overtones in the Matrix films, and the origins of the Church of the Flying Spaghetti Monster in educational protest are all central to the discussion within the framework of late modern society.

Perhaps what is most impressive in this text is Cusack's approach to such difficult material. These groups, most notably the Church of the SubGenius and Discordianism, often thrive on misdirection and disinformation, and as such can be extraordinarily difficult to approach in a scholarly fashion. Further, capturing the often ironic and absurdist spirit of these religions is challenging in an academic context, but is nonetheless an essential element of any discussion of such beliefs. Cusack has struck a comfortable balance in providing scholarly analysis while still maintaining something of the tone of the groups: no mean feat given the groups in question.

All in all, the text is an excellent scholarly positioning of a set of religious and spiritual approaches that are particularly difficult to locate within academic discussions. *Invented Religions* is an engaging and thoughtful work, and provides an articulate description of a number of groups that have generally been absent or under-theorized within scholarly discourse. This book significantly extends the discussion of invented religiosity as a valid form of spiritual engagement, and provides an important foundation text within this emergent field of research.

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ROBERT W. HEFNER, ed.: *Making Modern Muslims: The Politics of Islamic Education in Southeast Asia*. Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 2009; pp. viii + 246.

Making Modern Muslims is a comprehensive and much-needed comparative study of Islamic education and politics in Southeast Asia. The book is based on a three-year research project (December 2004 to January 2007) and draws on the collaborative effort of some of the leading scholars of Southeast Asian Islam. The book assesses Islamic schooling in Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Cambodia, and the Philippines.

We are reminded that Southeast Asia is home to the world's largest Islamic population, with Malaysia (60%) and Indonesia (87.8%) boasting the two largest Muslim

populations, worldwide. Readers are confronted with another salient point: that the Southeast Asian region has, since the early 2000s, been home to suspect terrorist groups. Continued unrest in these regions — in connection with radical Islamist movements — being somewhat the flavour of current media watch, remains a chief concern for the Western world. The big question being: can the Muslim world find its footing in modern civilization? Needless to say, the book certainly meets the agenda front on.

The editor, Robert W. Hefner, professor of anthropology at Boston University and director of the Institute on Culture, Religion and World Affairs (CURA), requires little introduction as a prolific author and researcher, and as a leading anthropologist specializing in Southeast Asian Islam. This compilation is certainly worthy of closer investigation as it offers valued insight through a critical analysis of the social realities concerning the politics of Islamic education in Southeast Asia. Indeed, Hefner carefully revisits the historical backdrop of Islam in Southeast Asia, within the context of education, honing in on the central importance of education within the Islamic community. In so doing, Hefner opens up old debates that seek to define the Islamic community as well as, provocatively, the way Muslims have been educated.

The Muslim world is well known for its *madrasas* (Muslim educational institution), the term literally meaning “a place where study and learning is conducted” — from the root “to learn, study.” In early Islamic communities, however, the *madrasas* consisted of a circle of disciples who followed one or a number of eminent religious scholars (*sheikhs*). The first *madrasas*, as “free-standing schools for intermediate and advanced religious learning” were established in the tenth century in Khurasan, northeastern Iran, from whence they spread westward and further abroad into Spain (7f). At its height, these *madrasas* educated “not only religious scholars but . . . the local cultural elite, including mathematicians, medical doctors, and astronomers” (p. 8). Yet ironically, this same institution was “recentred,” to use Hefner’s terminology, and by the end of the Middle Ages the *madrasa* was no longer the place of learning the “foreign sciences” (p. 9) but that of jurisprudence in its stead. Having excelled at mathematics, astronomy and medicine throughout the Middle Ages, the *madrasas* now removed all hints of foreign elements from the curricula with many jurists (*fuqaha*) finding its teachings obsolete and offensive to religion and law (p. 10). The eclipse of the “foreign sciences,” however, was soon to pass with its revival during the “great educational transformation of the modern era” (p. 10). In this light, Southeast Asian Muslim education has by and large been unique, compared to its Middle Eastern counterparts, in the way that it has responded to “colonial exploitation” (p. 42) and dealt with the postcolonial challenge. That is, the Muslims in these regions learned from foreign imposed (Christian) schools; their aim — not to bolster a Western state, but — to “create pious and knowledgeable Muslims, with a sense of allegiance to the community of believers (*umma*), however it be defined” (pp. 42–43).

Making Modern Muslims draws particular attention to the issue of the “old” and the “new” within Islam, which is seen as a struggle currently waged at the heart of the Islamic community. Yet, the same struggle has been ongoing, one can say, since the time of the death of the Prophet of Islam. The Muslim community, worldwide, is faced with the dilemma of how it must embrace change and diversity. Like all civilisations and religions, Islam is not alone in this quest; moreover, to be fair, Islam since before the collapse of its Golden Age had been a fine example of an open-minded, tolerating, and civil society — and it appears it can be so again. The problem with Islam, if we can so phrase it, today, is simply the “hardcore” division that now exists at its core — dividing not the Muslim populace in any significant way, but rather creating a negative impression at the hands of the few. The struggle for Islam to “modernize” and adapt to societal

needs of a changing world becomes the central debate of the book, albeit, the fate of which is argued to be in the hands of global Muslim educators and the Islamic educational institutions worldwide.

The book interestingly tips-off the reader to a most significant point: that religion is not the problem, but instead, and centrally, the way in which the religious community is educated. Hefner is attentive to the fact that education is, indeed, central to Islam as it is a duty incumbent upon every Muslim to learn and study (not just the Koran and Traditions), but to seek “knowledge” (K 39:9; K 20:114). Indeed, several *hadith* underline the importance for all Muslims to seek knowledge and learning. To quote Hefner, “schooling offers a unique formula for answering the question of how to carry Muslims forward into a modernity at once plural and open-minded yet religious” (p. 98). The greatest concern, however, with regard to Islamic school networks in Southeast Asia remains with the continued infiltration and influence of conservative groups (such as the Salafi in Cambodia), which may set the precedent for future resistance to progress and development in the education sector, and worse yet, turn school organizations into terrorist networks — the greatest fear being the covert takeover of the *madrasas* at the hands of radicals.

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MARGARET C. JACOB: *The Origins of Freemasonry: Facts and Fictions*. Philadelphia, PA: University of Pennsylvania Press, 2006; pp. 165.

In the last twenty-five years, Grand Lodge, Propaganda Due, the Bavarian Illuminati, and the “truth” behind Masonry itself, have taken something of a beating, from certain elements of the popular press and, increasingly, on the Internet. Books like *The Brotherhood* (1985) and *Jack the Ripper: The Final Solution* (1986) by Stephen Knight, *Inside the Brotherhood* (1986) by Martin Short, as well as the enormous popularity of Dan Brown’s *The Da Vinci Code* (2003) have added many layers of conspiracy theory and folklore to the already thick accretions which surround Freemasonry. This kind of contemporary folklore has made the study of the Western esoteric tradition in general and the history of Freemasonry in particular, very difficult. Because of this, any scholarly work that deals with the subject of Freemasonry is welcomed by academics in this area. Margaret Jacob’s *The Origins of Freemasonry: Facts and Fictions* is one such work; a scholarly book, written by an expert in the Enlightenment and the effect of post-Newtonian science on religion, which has taken up the task of stripping away the veil of hyperbole and hysteria which has been gathered around Freemasonry.

In this book, Jacob seeks to disentangle Freemasonry from the web of legends, folklore and conspiracy theories that have become interwoven with the society over the last century or so. Her overarching thesis is that Freemasonry is essentially an Enlightenment phenomenon, which had its roots in the gathering of impoverished English and Scottish guilds in the 1650s and went on to evolve into an organization that became intertwined with developing democratic movements.

The Origins of Freemasonry has investigated a number of aspects of Freemasonry that have, until now, escaped scholarly attention. One such area is the popularity of Masonic almanacs in the eighteenth century, which Jacob describes as often having a particularly “atheistic” tone, compared to almanacs published for a general audience. Jacob also deals with the way in which these almanacs can be analysed to show the

existence of ideas such as “Masonic time” and the development of Masonic creation myths and pseudo-histories. Another area, which has until recently been neglected, is the area of women in Freemasonry. Jacob devotes a chapter of her book to this subject, examining the area of female Freemasonry in France and the existence of mixed lodges under the umbrella of Grand Orient de France in the middle of the eighteenth century. The inclusion of these seldom-examined elements of Masonic history go together to make *The Origins of Freemasonry* a vitally important piece in the study of the history of Freemasonry.

Margaret Jacob is a highly credible writer in the field of Freemasonry and Enlightenment social movements in general. Her previous works have included *Living the Enlightenment: Freemasonry and Politics in Eighteenth Century Europe* (1991), which dealt with the role of Freemasonry in the emergence of the democratic movements in both America and France. Her writings are greatly esteemed in the field of post-Enlightenment esotericism and political philosophy. Her treatment of the subject of the history of Freemasonry has always been of high quality and *The Origins of Freemasonry* continues this trend of excellence.

The sources used in this work are of the highest standard. Jacob has included photographic reproductions of various original Masonic Lodge records taken from the Masonic library at the Prins Frederik Cultural Masonic Centre; the Library of the Grand Lodge, The Hague; the Library of Freemasons’ Hall, Philadelphia; and the records of the Grand Lodge in London, as well as some hundreds of other original documents taken from the same sources. Her bibliography of secondary sources is also exhaustive. It is clear that Jacob has researched her topic with the greatest thoroughness.

The Origins of Freemasonry is a work which answers the needs of the time in relation to esoteric and cultural studies. Considering the importance which Freemasonry holds in any scholarly examination of the Western esoteric tradition and the confusingly pervasive contemporary legends and folklore which surround Freemasonry, *The Origins of Freemasonry* is a book which is clear, well-presented, and serves to dispel some of the more fantastic legends which are circulated in popular books, television “documentaries,” and in the more fabulous areas of the Internet. Margaret Jacob’s *The Origins of Freemasonry* is a well-written, thoroughly researched, and meticulously referenced book, which has succeeded in confronting and debunking some of the hyperbole and legend that hampers the study of Freemasonry. Written by an expert on the Enlightenment and the post-Newtonian world, it is a thoughtful and valuable addition to the corpus of esoteric and cultural studies.

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TERRY RAY: *Bourdieu on Religion: Imposing Faith and Legitimacy*. London: Equinox, 2007; pp. xii + 181.

In *Bourdieu on Religion*, Terry Ray has produced a very useful introduction to the work of arguably France’s leading intellectual during the second half of the twentieth century, Pierre Bourdieu. The work examines what the author thought about religion (not much), and the ways, in his absence, that his work has been adopted by scholars of religion (varied and increasing). This book will be of immense use to any student of religion interested in either the phenomenology of religious expression, or the mechanisms through which religious life is reproduced through social practice.

Bourdieu was no friend of religion. He rarely considered it, and when he did it was as an example *par excellence* of the subtle and repressive process of symbolic violence; the naturalization of arbitrary power relationships and systems of meaning so that they are perceived by social actors as eternal, immutable, and objective facts of nature. As a classic “Master of Suspicion,” in the intellectual tradition of Marx, Durkheim, and Foucault, Bourdieu’s work effected to imply that religion was a form of particularly sinister symbolic violence, one that effectively masks arbitrary human whim as immutable divine law, and which establishes, legitimizes and reproduces social inequality and unjust political systems. “God is never anything other than society” Bourdieu was fond of stating (p. 80), and for him and those of his post-structuralist ilk, society is rarely anything other than repressive.

In a similar way to concepts of honour or duty, religion was analysed by Bourdieu as a socially sanctioned lie that allows us to accept the injustices of the world, and so it is little surprise that in his work Bourdieu paid no attention to the arguably more positive manifestations of religiosity. Personal and inward religious psychology apparently held little or no interest for him, nor did the wider roles of myth, symbol, mystical experience, or spirituality. Yet surprisingly, from this unpromising set of hoary modernist assumptions, Bourdieu’s theoretical concepts are increasingly being used by scholars of religion to examine some of the materialized and embodied expressions of religiosity and how these contribute to the social reproduction of religious life.

This duality of Bourdieu’s influence on the academic study of religion is admirably brought out in the book. It consists of five clearly written chapters that place Bourdieu in his historic context and give a very useful overview of how his work is being used by scholars of religion today. The book contains a good list of references on and by Bourdieu, separate from the bibliography, a rather less useful and more convoluted glossary of key terms, and each chapter closes with a helpful summary of the key points discussed.

Chapter one presents a biographical sketch of Bourdieu that places him in his own cultural context (his *habitus*), that of rising and triumphant French secularism and the waning of the importance of the Catholic church; a time when religious institutions were in decline and the heady, late-nineteenth-century secularization thesis was still very much the dominating narrative of the French academe. It is ironic that Bourdieu’s own *habitus*, that of a Marxist-influenced, mid-twentieth-century French modernist academic in the tradition of Sartre and Foucault, predisposed him to downplay religion, and to have a deep suspicion of “God talk.”

Chapter two provides a very useful coherent overview of the basic concepts of Bourdieu’s methodology. The concepts of “symbolic violence,” “field,” “*habitus*,” and “social capital” are all fully explored. This will assist newcomers to this field, especially when the book’s glossary provides such unhelpful definitions as “*Habitus* — the fundamental dimension of the individual as a social being that is at one and the same time the ‘matrix of perception’ and the seat and generator of dispositions” (p. 154), a rather terrifying collection of words which necessitates a substantial amount of tentative unpacking.

Chapter three applies a “Bourdieuquesq” theory of religious practice to the religious field of colonial Martha’s Vineyard, New England. Chapter four explains and assesses four of the most extensive applications of Bourdieu’s concepts in religious studies. These are Maduro’s examination of ritual and social conflict; Thomas Csordas’s “cultural phenomenology” of Catholic charismatic Christianity; Joan Martin’s womanist interpretation of the Christian work ethic; and Catherine Bell’s theorization of ritual practice. Bell, especially, has taken Bourdieu’s notion of practice in an exciting direc-

tion, one that Bourdieu himself would never have considered, by positing that ritual, rather than being a distinct type of action, can instead be considered a distinct aspect of all action, one that reproduces society through patterned interaction with a structured and enculturated social environment.

This brief exploration of Bell's use of Bourdieu (two pages) highlights the usefulness of Bourdieu's notions of practice and habitus in understanding how religion can permeate all aspects of the enculturated world. It is a shame that in focusing on Bourdieu's rather limited sociology of religion, where it is simply reduced to being ideological violence masked as social capital, this book has missed the opportunity to detail some of the more interesting aspects of the subject's thought. For instance, the concept of habitus is eminently suited to understanding forms of grounded and socialized religious practice, and has been extraordinarily useful for those scholars who want to move away from the centrality of texts in their examination of religion. But this is not a point that the author sufficiently explores.

One is left with the impression that the most useful and original elements of Bourdieu's social theory, such as practice as a relationship between habitual action and one's environment which recreates social meaning through time, are useful despite Bourdieu's cynical and rather derivative reductive and modernist notions of religion.

To my mind, the enormous *oeuvre* left by Bourdieu is important for the scholar of religion primarily because of his central notion of habitus, especially how it can be located in contexts traditionally seen as being peripheral to religious inquiry, such as our material surroundings, homes, landscapes, and patterns of routine daily life. Bourdieu's classic examination of the socialized space of the Berber House is one of the best examinations ever of how humans live and build their mythic worlds into their physical domestic surroundings. In retrospect, these flashes of insight makes his economic Marxist and functionalist reduction, his obsession with the Foucaultian unmasking of social inequality, and his fundamental disregard of the human religious experience as merely another veiled and sinister power institution, particularly unfortunate.

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ELISABETH ARWECK and WILLIAM KEENAN, eds.: *Materializing Religion: Expression, Performance and Ritual*. Aldershot, UK: Ashgate, 2006; pp. xvi + 241. Illus.

Part of the "Theology and Religion in Interdisciplinary Perspective Series," Arweck and Keenan's *Materializing Religion* presents a collection of fifteen papers that attempt to readdress the academic tendency to theologically and textually define religion and present it as largely ethereal and detached from the material world. The collection focuses on varied academic discussions of the "materializing" elements of religion, mostly material expressions of religious spaces or examinations of practice-based ritual. The papers are presented from either an ethnographic or sociological perspective. For those interested in performance, objects, and practice in religious life, this will be a useful collection of well-presented papers examining the process of religious materialization. The papers included, however, offer little attempt to engage with the broader conceptual and structural issues of how religion relates to the material world, and thus the book offers little to those whose primary interest may be more theoretical, say in the reciprocal dialogue between religious experience and material culture.

That said, there is much here to keep any sociologist or anthropologist of religion interested, with chapters focusing on religion and architecture, sacred space, landscape, ritual performance and choreography, festivals, dance, dress, music, magic, iconography, and symbols. The papers are drawn from an equally diverse range of academically trained authors, including sociologists, anthropologists, dancers, Wiccans, and PhD students, and this gives the volume an interdisciplinary and eclectic character, which is useful for an exploratory subject like this. This wide variability in theme and approach is particularly appropriate and useful in an emerging field that is, as the editors rightly point out, currently in an exciting pre-paradigmatic stage of development.

Unfortunately, the same level of variability is not reflected in the range of religious traditions addressed: nine of the fifteen chapters focus on Christianity, mainly Pentecostal, Catholic or Nonconformist, three on the New Age or Wicca, with only one looking at a non-Western religious tradition (chapter twelve, which examines Tibetan religious expression and identity in contemporary New York).

The introductory chapter by the editors strives to make the point that the concept of religion is largely unintelligible outside its incarnation in material expression, and they are broadly successful in achieving this aim. They are also at pains to present the exciting and fluid nature of the nascent field of materialization and religion. Inexplicably, however, they choose not to engage with any theoretical exploration of the relationship between the “spiritual” and the “material,” and the names of a number of major theorists who have already explored the complex relationship between perception and materialized practice are noteworthy in their absence; most notably, Heidegger, Merleau-Ponty, Bourdieu, Otto, Eliade, Yi-Fu Tuan, and Alfred Gell.

This chapter is written with verve and colour, but sometimes to the detriment of clarity (“when dealing with things of the spirit, matter matters inordinately”), and this lack of clarity is reinforced by a tendency for the writing to veer toward a strangely scriptural tone (“by their material expressions shall they be known”). This insistence on biblical language, and the thinking that informs it, has the effect of prolonging, rather than clarifying or problematizing, the traditional polarity between the spiritual and the material in Christian theology. For instance, to state in the introduction that “the perennial quest, ever ancient, ever new, to give material shape and substance to spiritual insight and religious longing” merely serves to recapitulate the long-standing dichotomy between matter and spirit that has invidiously worked its way into so much academic commentary on religion. This academic repackaging of a deeply held Christian assumption is further illustrated in the editor’s insistence in adopting the term “artworks” to refer to all such material expressions; the connotation being that the materialized elements of religion function like art: they are reflective, secondary, and ornamental. Overall, the authors present the material expressions of religion as conscious attempts by worshipers to materialize a deeper or more primary spiritual truth that exists in some rarefied realm beyond the material, rather than as a semi-autonomous realm of active and engaged meaning, production, and agency. This does little to encourage any understanding of an active or reflexive relationship between religion and materiality that is mutually creative.

Chapter two is a contemplative and sensitive exploration of how memory and a changing sense of identity are drawn from a religious landscape that is slowly losing its association with the sacred. The focus is a collection of post-industrial churches in southern Wales. The question is what happens when memories change, through increased secularization and a popular retreat from the churches, but the material shells of churches remain and decay in the landscape? The article provides few answers but points to the fascinating question of “leftover materiality”, which is the process whereby

religious structures become profane buildings (the church becoming a warehouse for carpets), or eventually ruins?

Chapter three focuses on architectural forms and symbols and presents an examination of the meaning of the highly utilitarian spaces inside Quaker halls and Charismatic Universalist Church buildings. The chapter presents a spatially sensitive approach to religious architecture that charts the narrow path between disregard for the material reality of religious life and the overly deterministic position that material spaces largely structure religious experience. The chapter posits one of the most sophisticated methodological approaches to material agency in the collection, suggesting that the meaning of built spaces is constantly created and negotiated through use, rather than being a univocal result of fixed symbolic spatiality.

Similarly, chapter six provides a semiotic analysis of the changing use of space within Pentecostal assembly halls. The paper charts a move within these halls towards experiential involvement, dancing, trance, music and performance — to the extent that, in many, the lectern itself has eventually disappeared to be replaced by a drum kit. Here the changes to the physical layout of the “churches” reveal deeper changes in religious experience and attitude. It is simply suggested that these material changes reflect prior mental shifts, rather than the two realms influencing one another and mutually creating a shifting habitus within the religious community.

“Materialization” does not solely refer to spaces and structures, however, and many of the papers in the collection explore the wider connotations of the term. Chapter four, for instance, uses a material metaphor, that of “wrapping” — taken from the ethnography of Japanese gift presentation and giving — to examine the layers of embellishment, or “wrappings,” that surround Nonconformist ritualized worship. Instead of being egalitarian and accessible, worship is shown to be wrapped in subtle layers of pomp and ritual that ensure inaccessibility to outsiders and newcomers, and give the proceedings an added aura of significance and mystery. Chapter seven looks at dance, a materially embodied religious practice, and describes how European Christians are appropriating dance forms from non-Christian cultures to innovate a new style of religious dance for the West. This can be paired with chapter eleven, which examines music as a loosely “materialized” form of religious technology.

Chapter eight is a primarily descriptive account of a particular type of materialized religion — Wicca. Although it only touches on the material elements of Wiccan ritual in a tangential manner, and is mostly concerned with an ethnographic description of ritual practice, the chapter provides one of the best short introductions to contemporary Wiccan ritual and the appeal that it holds for the spiritually alienated and socially marginalized.

Chapter thirteen, by Katheryn Rountree, furthers this examination of the material aspects of contemporary magic praxis by providing a sensitive exploration of the practice of spell casting in feminist witchcraft circles in New Zealand. Rountree, in addition to presenting a useful introduction to feminist witchcraft, argues that material objects are used in rituals, not because they are thought to hold intrinsic powers, but because they embody the idea of transformation in the psychological and habitual life of the spell caster, and that they effect this change through functioning as active symbols. Ritual action is not thought by its performers to rely on any distinction between externalized objective material objects and internalized subjective thoughts, but rather to transcend this dualism and work in a holistic fashion. Nor is the ritual use of material objects formalized or prescriptive, but instead it is an intuitive and creative process where the objects hold less intrinsic power than the will and motivation of the woman, which fits with the feminist emphasis on personal self-empowerment.

Overall, while not fully exploring many of the wider implications of the way materialization and religion interact and reinforce one another, nor completely shedding a theological word-first perspective, the papers in this book present a series of fascinating case studies that go some way to asserting a materialist position in religious studies, a discipline that has for too long emphasized the word to the exclusion of the paper, vellum, or stone that it has inevitably been inscribed upon.

JULIAN DROOGAN
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JOHN HAYMAN: *Sir Richard Burton's Travels in Arabia and Africa: Four Lectures from a Huntington Library Manuscript*. San Marino, CA: Huntington Library, 2005; pp. 109. Illus.

Sir Richard Burton, the quintessential Victorian adventurer, gentleman explorer, and connoisseur of the forbidden pleasures of Empire, reputedly spoke twenty-nine languages and published over forty-six works recounting his somewhat eccentric meanderings through the far corners of the early-Victorian world. For readers drawn to his sensitive, erudite, and often hilarious accounts of non-European cultures and religions at a time when modernity was just beginning its march with empire into the dark interiors of Africa and Asia, this slim book will come as a delight. It is a transcription of four lectures given by Burton in Brazil in 1866, recounting his attempts to penetrate in disguise the holy Islamic shrines at Medina and Mecca, the "hidden" city of Harar in East Africa, and the West African state of Dahomey. Part traveller's tales, part early ethnography written by an astute and enquiring mind, this book has much to offer an academic reader.

For a studies-in-religion audience it will most likely be Burton's memoirs of his participation in the Hajj that will kindle the most immediate interest. Burton writes as a sincere admirer of Islam, and his accounts of joining Hajji pilgrims to the holy places of Mecca and Medina reveal an admirable ability to enter imaginatively into the sacred experience of the pilgrimage. His writing is peppered with a wealth of detail, and infused with a surprising level of enthusiasm ("El Islam is a creed remarkable for common sense") that is refreshing to read in the post-9/11 world. Burton's descriptions of the Hajj are full of detail: historical, geographic, architectural, and mythological. Yet his observations always return, with almost anthropological precision, to the ways men and women act, to the moments that relieve the tedium of a long caravan ride, or the sense of the holy that suffuses a campfire in the evening.

Burton's evocative and romantic prose, interspaced with moments of poetry, is at times also wonderfully dry, cynical, and anti-authoritarian, the product of a somewhat crusty Burton looking back on his exploits as an authoritative citizen of the world. Delightfully, the writing is punctured with those classic stoic understatements of the Victorian gentleman explorer ("here I had the displeasure of being stalked by a lion"); less pleasantly, it is also often permeated with an uncomfortable Spencerian assumption of racial superiority ("The true negroes, distinguished by the long, ape-like head, the projecting jaws, bowed shins and elongated heels and forearms").

For those not familiar with Burton's writings, these four candid and pithy essays are a perfect introduction to his remarkable adventures, as well as the rich religious worlds he passed through. The brevity of the lectures serves to heighten the positives (high

escapade and adventure, wry comments, sensitive observations), while smoothing over the negatives (Burton's tendency to lecture on obscure comments, entangle the reader in what are now obscure debates, and occasional outbursts of anti-authoritarian and egotistical diatribe).

JULIAN DROOGAN
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HANAN ESHEL: *The Dead Sea Scrolls and the Hasmonean State*. Grand Rapids: William B. Eerdmans Publishing, 2008; pp. xii + 208.

In this work, author Hanan Eshel uses the Dead Sea Scrolls to illuminate the political complexities of the Hasmonean state in the mid-second through first centuries BCE. Though the Dead Sea Scrolls have received considerable scholarly attention, they have not been evaluated for their ability to provide valuable information about politics. By establishing a historical framework through which to interpret the Scrolls, Eshel effectively demonstrates that these documents not only reflect their respective historical period, but offer new details.

The Hasmonean period is described in several sources, First and Second Maccabees, the Book of Daniel, and in the most detail, the works of Josephus. Regarding the latter, Eshel notes that while Josephus offers much information, most of what he recounts about the Hasmonean state comes from the work of Nicolaus of Damascus, who was a friend of Herod and hostile towards the Hasmoneans. This bias is evident in Josephus' contradictory accounts, and as Eshel notes, this affects the overall quality and reliability of his work. Other sources provide very chronologically limited accounts.

The Dead Sea Scrolls offer an as yet unexplored solution to the above-mentioned problems; however, they are not without their own challenges. As Eshel observes, there are over 900 scrolls that cover a wide range of genres, from religious texts to commentaries and laws. Additionally, some of the texts were written by members of the Qumran community, while others were brought to the group by new members. Of the extant sources, many are fragmentary, and they utilize obscure or veiled language. It is the latter that has led some historians to question the Scrolls' ability to provide information about current events. To the contrary, Eshel contends that the *pesharim*, which were written by members of the community who thought they were living in the end of days, contain allusions to current events.

Eshel focuses on three historical figures, Jonathan son of Mattathias, John Hyrcanus, and Alexander Jannaeus and five figures described in the Scrolls, the Teacher of Righteousness, the Wicked Priest, the Man of Lie, the Man of Belial, and the Lion of Wrath. He argues that messianic expectations form the origin of the group that would surround the Teacher of Righteousness, whom he identifies as the leader of the Qumran group. In contrast to the Teacher, the Wicked Priest is likely Jonathan. The Qumran community spoke out against John Hyrcanus, whom Eshel identifies with the Man of Belial mentioned in the peshar on Josh. 6:26. Lastly, Eshel argues that the Lion of Wrath is Alexander Jannaeus.

Ultimately, Eshel's work offers a valuable contribution to the field. He builds upon a substantial body of scholarship and gives new interpretations based upon a remarkable integration of archaeological and literary evidence.

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DANIEL RYNHOLD: *An Introduction to Medieval Jewish Philosophy*. London: I. B. Tauris, 2009; pp. xii + 256.

In this medium-sized volume, Assistant Professor Daniel Rynhold of Yeshiva University, NY, treats the most important philosophical streams explored through the works of a selected group of medieval Jewish thinkers. The book maps a very clear progression, starting from Saadia Gaon, Isaac Israeli, Judah Halevi, Moses Maimonides, Levi Gersonides, and completed with Hasdai Crescas. The book paints a comprehensible picture of Jewish philosophy and its subtle relationship with the medieval Arabic interpreters of Greek philosophy. The first theme in chapter one is "The Existence of God" where comparisons between Maimonides and Halevi, as well as others, are made in an accessible way. The second chapter, "God and Creation", turns with precision to the detailed arguments of the Aristotelian idea of "causation" and its infiltration by the Neoplatonic theory of emanation. The chapter ends with a debate about the limits of theology and rationalistic thought, which is likewise clear and contains within its pages the basic arguments to allow for a further study of the subject. The discussion of the Divine Attributes is introduced through quotes from the works of Saadia, Maimonides, and Gersonides who offers a critique of the philosophical interpretation of Maimonides.

The author deals in depth with the classical text of the medieval thinkers and his declared intention is to lead the reader to wonder and explore further these beliefs and arguments. The meaning of Prophecy is exposed from the esoteric perspective of Maimonides and the more traditional view held by Halevi. Chapter five is concerned with the "Commandments" and the way of looking at them, either as a rational thing to observe based on reason, or as a revelation grounded in the Jewish tradition. The author explains the philosophical arguments pursued by Saadia and the rationality of submitting to commandments. Maimonides shares the teleological explanations of the first cause in Aristotle where commandments are a part of a natural and eternal law. The author builds his arguments from philosophy to theology and shows the subtle nuances of the basic ideas and their consequences for the topic at hand. Chapter six on "Freewill and Omniscience" begins with a quote from Hasdai Crescas on the principle of choice, then brings us back into the lively debate of our medieval thinkers, Saadia, Halevi, and Maimonides, which leaves us with as many questions as answers in such speculative, philosophical, and rational arenas. Finally, the book concludes with a presentation of the "Good Life" where the ultimate perfection of man is practical. The book contains a rich variety of subjects and debates that is perfectly adequate to whet the appetite of all types of readers genuinely interested in Jewish philosophy. Thus, it will be of great benefit to undergraduates in philosophy and for lay persons without any background in philosophy who are interested in some fundamental themes in metaphysics.

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JUDITH M. RICHARDS: *Mary Tudor*. London and New York: Routledge, 2008; pp. xiv + 264.

Judith Richards's new biography of Mary Tudor offers a fresh and insightful analysis of a period of English church history which has been significantly investigated over the last twenty-five years. Richards's contribution offers an excellent introduction, especially for undergraduate students, to a specific period of history that is often dwarfed by the

attention which is given in textbooks to reigns of Henry VIII, Edward VI, and Elizabeth I. The author carefully sets her study in the wider context of the Henrician Reformation and helps the reader to understand the complexity of issues facing Mary when she became England's first female monarch (excluding Queen Matilda who was never crowned in 1135, and the nine-day rule of Queen Jane). In an attempt to rehabilitate "Bloody Mary," Richards helps the reader to understand the social, political, economic, and religious context in which she reigned, suggesting that she did so with more success than is often attributed to her.

The book maps out the history of the Tudor dynasty, taking time to help the reader trace the move from the Plantagenet family to that of the Tudor, thereby enabling the audience to understand the way in which Henry VIII dealt ruthlessly with perceived claimants to his dynastic heritage. The peculiar circumstances of Mary's birth and early life indicate the way in which she suffered as a result of her mother's "divorce." Yet, at various times, such as the period following her father's marriage to Jane Seymour, and especially after December 1542 when she was brought back to court, she was encouraged by her father to pursue her love of learning. This helps us to see that far from being a bigot of popular historiography, she encouraged a humanist reform of the Church which she loved. Richards writes of the way she collaborated with Katherine Parr's role in having some of Erasmus's *Paraphrases upon the New Testament* translated into English, with Mary serving as one of the translators. Indeed, during her own reign, she had taken steps, despite Cardinal Pole's reservations, to produce a new "orthodox" English translation of the New Testament, hardly the action of a reactionary Catholic.

The author follows a predictable, yet insightful, revisionist survey of the period, demonstrating that the enduring nature of popular religion in both Henry VIII and Edward VI's reigns was not that of Protestantism but rather that of popular Roman Catholicism, in terms of piety and liturgy. The Northern risings during her father's reign not only showed the concern of the populace over the monastic reforms but also Mary's own popularity within the realm, a factor that indicates how skilled she had become in prudent "royal inscrutability." Mary was well aware of the problems associated with appealing to papal authority but refused to reverse the changes which her Father had introduced in proclaiming himself "supreme head of the Church of England." She never abandoned her commitment to the traditional celebration of the mass, even when during her brother's reign it could have led to her downfall. In fact, during this period the author clearly shows the way in which Edward's counselors enriched her so that she was able to live a more independent life than even her father had envisioned.

The popular concern, at Edward's death, that Mary was the legitimate heir to the throne, not only demonstrates the prevailing concern for aspects of popular piety, but also for a proper legal transfer of power. Richards cites the way in which even Thomas Cranmer expressed serious concerns over Edward's preference for Lady Jane, as a Protestant claimant to the throne. The contrast between Jane's silent procession through the streets of London and the exuberant welcome Mary received, with a *Te Deum* being sung at various churches, including St Paul's where an organ was used for the first time since Edward's regime banned its use, indicates that two periods of "reform" had not obliterated the orthodox faith from the lives of English men and women.

Richards helps us to understand not only the problems which Mary faced when she became Queen, in the context of a religiously unstable and economically difficult time (with bad harvests and an influenza epidemic in 1556–1558), but also how she surmounted these obstacles to be successful as England's first female monarch. She also demonstrates that although Mary observed the traditional rites of her religion, she would not compel others until Parliament had made its "common consent." This latter

desire would prove problematic in the House of Commons, where heated and acrimonious debates often indicated the divisions within the nation as a whole. It was, however, her marriage to Philip of Spain which caused most resentment, not only because of his religious persuasions, but because she was marrying a foreigner who might influence England's foreign policy. That this did not happen is an indication of how astute a monarch Mary actually proved to be.

It is, however, Mary's lasting memory of a persecutor of Protestants that is much more difficult to accommodate with her humanist learning. Richards attempts to set the killings within the wider context of "heresy" trials in Europe in the sixteenth century, suggesting that many Protestant families actually prospered under her reign and that the crucial test was obedience to the law, rather than Catholic orthodoxy. Yet it is difficult to ignore the 300 burnings that occurred during her reign, even if we do not accept the way in which Foxe used these events as Protestant propaganda. A revisionist reading of the history of this period can sometimes go too far in the opposite direction.

Richard's book is an excellent introduction to the study of Mary Tudor. Undergraduate students will benefit from the careful scholarship which this volume demonstrates. It will also whet the appetite for further reflection on a period of English church history that was more vibrant than many have realized.

KENNETH B. E. ROXBURGH
Samford University

JOHN H. DARCH: *Missionary Imperialists? Missionaries, Government and the Growth of the British Empire in the Tropics, 1860–1885*. Milton Keynes: Paternoster Press, 2009; pp. xxii + 279.

This work comes out of the stable of the Paternoster Press Studies in Christian Thought and History. Largely focused on evangelical Christianity, this book, while attending to evangelical missions in tropical Africa and the south-west Pacific in the mid-Victorian period, also ranges more widely. It includes an examination of the Melanesian Mission, and the Universities' Mission to Central Africa, missions of High Church Anglicans. The book focuses on British missions in the mid-Victorian period, one less studied by historians than its successor, the period of high imperialism and the peak of missionary expansion in the late Victorian decades. Six case studies are offered, examining, in addition to the High Church Anglican missions, the missions of the Church Missionary Society, the London Missionary Society, the Wesleyan Methodist Missionary Society, and the (Presbyterian) New Hebrides Mission. The connecting link between the six studies is found to be that they were all missions that came under the examination of the British government through the Colonial or the Foreign Office during this period. So the case studies are able to offer insights into the connections between missions and the expansion of British imperial influence at this time, which is the subject of the book.

This book is one of an increasing number of studies beginning to investigate the complexities and nuances of the relationship between missions and imperialism, which builds on the work of historians such as Brian Stanley and Andrew Porter. In contrast to older studies such as Ajayi, these historians wish to move away from a simplistic connection that saw missions as simply the agents of western imperialism. Inevitably, Darch finds that the various missions, and their missionaries, had a varied approach to European imperialism, predominantly in the form of the British Empire, though the Presbyterian and Anglican missionaries in the Pacific were also involved with Australian imperialism.

Undoubtedly, the most valuable aspect of the book is the attention Darch draws to the influence and outcomes wrought both by mission supporters in Britain, and the network that existed between missionaries and their metropolitan supporters in support of missionary agendas. These two groups could work in harmony for goals which either furthered British imperial interests, or opposed them. They did so usually in the interests, as the missionaries perceived them, of the indigenous peoples the missionaries were seeking to evangelize. The New Hebrides and Melanesian missionaries successfully lobbied against the practice of indentured Pacific labour in Queensland; but this helped prepare the ground for a British protectorate in Papua New Guinea. More directly, the Wesleyan missionaries and their metropolitan supporters successfully lobbied for British annexation of Fiji, and also in Papua New Guinea, due to the pressure of the European freebooters who were part of the flotsam and jetsam of empire. In The Gambia, however, missionary pressure was largely ineffective, compared with commercial interests, in achieving greater British oversight; and in Yorubaland the CMS missionaries lost confidence in the eventual government intervention, a similar outcome to the post-annexation situation in Fiji. Finally, in east and central Africa, the missions largely focused on anti-slave trade work and evangelism, but their substantial presence in the region provided the grounds for the later British grab for east African territory.

The book very usefully elaborates on a distinction devised by the economic imperial historians Cains and Hopkins between an "imperialism of result" and an "imperialism of intent." This allows Darch to acknowledge the diverse imperialist outcomes of these six missionary case studies, and to see these as predominantly secondary outcomes to the fundamental evangelistic agenda of these missions. The direct lobbying of missions for annexation in the case of Fiji, for example, does raise questions about the supposed unintentionality of the imperialism of some Christian missions.

A final important dimension to the work is the relationship between Christianity and culture in the history of the modern missionary movement. Christianity could not have expanded in this period divorced from the context of the European cultures that formed it; which meant that missionaries were inevitably "purveyors of 'civilized' values." Some missions, however, demonstrated greater awareness of this connection in their relationship with others, and were, consequently, more sympathetic to indigenous cultures. Interestingly, Darch ascribes this sympathy to churchmanship (p. 31), rather than to the more obvious difference between Anglican and Nonconformist missions. Evangelicals, whether Nonconformist or Anglican, with their emphasis on individual salvation and ethical standards, were more antithetical to tribal cultures; whereas the High Church tradition, with its concern for ecclesiastical tradition, was more receptive to communal indigenous cultures. Darch, therefore, raises the importance of ecclesiastical culture and theology as a necessary component of missionary and imperial history.

ROWAN STRONG
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JAY JOHNSTON: *Angels of Desire: Esoteric Bodies, Aesthetics and Ethics*. London and Oakville: Equinox Press, 2008; pp. vi + 288.

It is now some years since Antoine Fauvre diagnosed the marginalization of esotericism within the academy as a function of its transdisciplinary approach, on the one hand, and the inherently indeterminate nature of its subject, on the other. Fauvre's attempts to bring some clarification to this field anticipated an upsurge of academic interest in this

topic, which focused in particular on the influence of esoteric ideas and motifs within the human (and, to a lesser extent, also the natural) sciences. There remains a good deal of work still to be done to reveal the esoteric influences on contemporary philosophy, by way of such pivotal figures as Hegel, Schopenhauer, Nietzsche, and Freud, among others.

This book is a representative of one of the avenues such research may take. Johnston draws on the many suggestions of esoteric influence scattered through the writings of recent French philosophers, but is most clearly inspired by the explicit appeal to such themes in the work of Luce Irigaray. Prominent in Irigaray's philosophy is the theme of desire, expressed in the lover's embrace. Johnston traces this theme to theosophical, romantic, and tantric philosophies, drawing out and carefully untangling the web of conceptual correlations between these sources and their contemporary expression. So too the theme of angelic visitation: Johnston uncovers resonances with the philosophy that inspires the Tarot.

Johnston's thesis is that the bodily presence envisaged within these sources is of a "subtle body," a body that operates between the traditional binaries of corporeal and spiritual, mind and body. Like Irigaray, Johnston's primary concern is to develop a theory of ethical intersubjectivity, and this leads her to stress the possibilities of mediation in "the interval of the between," using the relation of male and female as exemplary. Her work is particularly important in its detailed defence of the claim that individual subjectivity is not dissolved by the intersubjective relation, but sustained by it. The cultivation of perceptual awareness of intersubjectivity produces "temporal, porous and inherently open subjects" that are ethically driven by responsibility to the other (p. 88). Johnston substantiates this thesis with a substantial body of research of both Eastern and Western traditions, revealing Vedic and Buddhist influences on the one hand, and Hegelian and Bergsonian influences on the other.

Johnston's work is no doubt subject to those very charges that Fauvre identified as having delayed the study of esotericism in general: the wide-ranging nature of her appeal to sources is striking, as is the fluidity of her passage from the one to the other. This is a strength of the work, rather than a detraction. The difficulty of research such as this is not so much its breadth of vision, but keeping sight of the tensions within these approaches themselves, tensions which become exaggerated when the diverse sources are juxtaposed. Clearly, if the point is to show that esoteric material is influential on contemporary thought, the argument is hardly served by stressing the tensions within and between esoteric strands — nor again, the tensions within the philosophical strands they are taken to influence. Nevertheless, the juxtaposition of these sources raises more questions than it answers — as befits an appeal to the esoteric.

For example, how exactly is the both/and of the mediated spirit/body to be related to the neither/nor of the divine intervention that the angel enacts? Does the transmutation of the heavenly encounter serve merely to spiritualize bodies, or does it turn them into something else again? Let us take, for instance, the angelic visitation that springs to mind from the Christian milieu: that of Gabriel to Mary. Surely the angel's visit occurs in order to proclaim the existence of a body — that of Mary — that is not merely *spiritualized*, but rendered altogether *miraculous*. The miracle, as I understand it, is that her body can be expropriated to a higher cause that is not properly her own, but rather that of God.

The transmutation of both the spiritual and the corporeal required for recognition of the angelic intervention is certainly deep and ongoing, as Johnston claims. But the epiphanic nature of this intervention is downplayed where it is situated in the "interval" between concepts of spirit and body; whether these concepts are as traditionally conceived or otherwise. This angelic intervention might just as well be used to show the

insufficiency of any notions of spirit and body, as to show the sufficiency of either, if mediated by the other. Johnston is right to identify in the symbol of the angelic body a potent stimulant to this discussion; her work frequently points to an even greater role for this symbol. So I look forward to her ongoing exploration of this theme with interest. But if her sources are indeed esoteric, in any full-blooded sense, then this suggests a propensity to transgress concepts of spirit and body, not merely to bring about a refiguration of their relation, each to the other.

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METTE B. BRUUN and STEPHANIE A. GLASER, eds.: *Negotiating Heritage: Memories of the Middle Ages*. Turnhout: Brepols, 2008; pp. 396.

This volume is the result of conference proceedings in December 2004 at the University of Copenhagen's Centre for the Study of the Cultural Heritage of Medieval Rituals. The conference, entitled "The Cultural Heritage of Medieval Rituals III: Confronting Heritage," brought together a *force majeure* of Northern European scholars who specialize in the transmission of legacy, and, therefore, heritage, throughout the centuries using diverse means of interpretation. The collection of papers examines the multiple ways and varied processes by which heritage is transmitted from one period to another such as through custom, legend, or idea. The volume is compartmentalized into four important subsets: "Authority and Heritage," "Ritual Commemoration," "Memory and Oblivion," and "Artistic Negotiations with Medieval Heritage."

The introductory chapter by Mette B. Bruun and Stephanie A. Glaser artfully defines legacy as that which is "consciously reintegrated into other contexts or transformed into new shapes in order to create dialogue, or, as is also the case, to establish a dissonance between past and present" (p. 2). Aspects of a legacy can be "forgotten, rejected, distorted, or even obliterated" (p. 2). Heritage as cultural history is further defined as "a product of negotiation" (p. 3) due to its recreation or reinvention of aspects of the past. The past is viewed as double-sided: nostalgia competing with the desire for modernity.

The first section, "Authority and Heritage," examines the concept of inheritance and techniques of transference of legacy through examination of authors, texts, and the desire for a new authority. Mette B. Bruun's contribution, "Wilderness as 'Lieu de Mémoire'" (incidentally, my favourite of all the contributions) analyses the texts which describe Cistercian monastic foundations, with their emphasis on the wilderness as the embodiment of the spiritual and ascetic characteristics so strongly identified with Cistercian identity. Bruun traces the changing nature of the metaphor of the wilderness though both medieval and seventeenth-century sources, finding that the precise degree of "wilderness" (p. 42) varies from text to text, and was dependent on the current thinking on the Cistercian Golden Age.

Mia Münster-Swendsen's paper, "The Transfer of Charismatic Power in Medieval Scholarly Culture c. 1000–1230" considers the social practices of medieval teaching and learning and the inherent power relations within such settings, finding that the master's position in the early universities was a precarious one, subject to the balance of power remaining constant between master and student. Alexander André's paper on Gilbert the Universal's *Gloss on Lamentations* studies the introduction of the *ars rhetorica* to biblical studies in the twelfth century, finding the adaptation of an old literary device establishes a link of transmission to classical antiquity which, while it cannot be considered a startling conclusion, still provides a relevant discussion.

Jørgen Bruhn's examination of the question of authority in Chrétien de Troyes judges that the author believed that literature need not be based on authoritative sources, and that fictive characters "did not in the least diminish the importance of literature" (p. 82). This dichotomy between the original text and the newly worked exposition of the text was exploited by Chrétien when he alluded to non-existent sources for his *Erec et Enide*, and has in turn inspired a well-known subgenre as demonstrated by Borges and Eco, and lately and most unfortunately, by Dan Brown, of the deliberately misleading introduction and references.

The second section of the volume entitled, "Ritual and Commemoration" deals with such varied topics as the sacramental bread and wine, Colbert's memorial medals, and the historical archives of New Zealand. The overriding methodology, however, of the preservation of cultural and/or religious heritage remains constant despite such great leaps in time and space. Of particular interest are the papers by Stijn Bossuyt on foundation rituals in churches in Flanders and Arjo Vanderjagt's paper on the court of the Valois dukes of Burgundy in the fifteenth century, which focuses on the utilization of the tale of Jason and the Argonauts for political and religious propaganda purposes.

The third section, "Memory and Oblivion," opens with Wim Verbaal's article on Bernard of Clairvaux's School of Oblivion. Verbaal argues that not only is Bernard the master of the "purged memory" (p. 225), saturating his reader with the Word but is also capable of running a "true school of oblivion" (p. 222). The final section on "Artistic Negotiations with Medieval Heritage" extends reflections on memory and heritage to the arts, looking at the homage paid to medieval heritage in architecture, painting, theatre, music, and literature. Jens Fleischer looks at *spolia*, architectural fragments in modern buildings. Carravaggio's Last Supper challenged conventional notions of beauty and saintliness, according to Svein Aage Christoferson. Magnar Breivik and Nils Holger Peterson round off the volume with fascinating articles about the incorporation of medieval themes and musical elements into contemporary musical compositions. This volume is highly recommended for anyone interested in medieval legacies to contemporary society.

YVETTE DEBERGUE
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CYNTHIA WHITE: *The Emergence of Christianity*. Westport, CT: Greenwood Press, 2007; pp. xxxvi + 224.

Cynthia White's *The Emergence of Christianity* proves to be an effective and insightful text that would be useful for any introductory course on early Christianity or early church history. While not a biblical scholar or theologian, White is a classics scholar who is fully conversant with ancient Latin texts and Roman history. As such, the book's strength lies in its ability to approach the emergence of Christianity through the lens of Roman historians and politicians. In so doing, White delivers a compelling account of the early years of Christianity, its collusion with Roman politics, and its open confrontation with pagans and other non-Christians. The book's clear and concise writing makes it easily accessible to students, and the inclusion of a glossary, inset sections with biographical information on the major figures of early Christendom, and insets with selections from various Roman or early church writings results in a robust introductory textbook. White includes chapters on Christianity's early relationship to Judaism, the persecution and later tolerance of Christianity in the Roman Empire, the Christianiza-

tion of Rome, and the contentious relationship between Christians and pagans. These chapters are littered with historical facts, brief narrative descriptions, and careful scholarship on significant issues, such as the antagonism between Christian monotheism and Roman god/goddess worship. The sixth chapter concludes the book by briefly retracing its major arguments and historical points, recapitulating the rise of Christianity from Jewish sect to Roman religion, before giving a cursory overview of the next one thousand plus years of Christian history. This chapter touches on the Crusades, the Inquisitions, the Reformation, and the modern ecumenist movement, offering a few paragraphs on each. The several pages of the chapter however, might have better served the reader if they had extended discussions glossed over or completely omitted from previous chapters. For instance, Augustine does not make an appearance in White's book, and it is difficult to image a text on early Christianity without such a key figure. Nevertheless, White does masterfully demonstrate the intricate ties between Christianity and Roman politics and religion in the first few centuries of the Common Era. Moreover, she condenses a great deal of historical data, anecdotes, and exegesis of classical Latin texts into a concise and accessible book. This book will serve as a valuable resource for students in introductory courses, as it provides the reader with opportunities to engage excerpts from ancient texts and familiarizes the reader with many of the principal figures in early Christianity.

JEREMY FACKENTHAL
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JORIS VAN EIJNATTEN, ed.: *Preaching, Sermon, and Cultural Change in the Long Eighteenth Century*. Leiden: Brill, 2009; pp. xv + 413.

Since the 1980s, the study of sermons has greatly expanded, and there has been much interest in sermons preached during the "long" eighteenth century. This is scarcely surprising. Religious history (rather than narrower "church" or "ecclesiastical" history) generally has become fashionable. The sermon is an ideal subject for inter-disciplinary analysis. Its investigation is a part of the investigation of the period's "public sphere."

Preaching, Sermon, and Cultural Change in the Long Eighteenth Century is the fourth volume of Brill's New History of the Sermon, and its scope is very wide. Obviously its chronology is lengthy, but, additionally, it investigates, compares, and contrasts preaching over huge geographical areas — a range of European states and also North America. It examines the sermons of the Roman Catholic Church and many Protestant denominations. Such broad coverage is possible because the subject-matter is arranged by coherent, though overlapping, themes ("Survey," "Foundation," "Transformation," and "Communication"). Under these headings, there are nine detailed and impressive essays, and there is also a useful preface which, *inter alia*, summarizes the chapters.

The scope of the volume is emphasized by the opening essay, "Varieties of Sermon," by O. C. Edwards Jr. This is a *tour de force*. Edwards surveys Catholic, Anglican, Lutheran, and Reformed preaching; sermons on particular days (including saints' days, fast days, civic occasions, and funerals), political sermons, and sermons grounded on history. The first essay under "Foundation," by Alexander Bitzel, explores in detail the theology of the sermon — Roman Catholic and Protestant — showing the influence of particular figures, and changing trends, the result, for instance, of Pietist or Enlightenment theology. "The Roman Catholic sermon in the Enlightenment context," Bitzel

concludes, “differed only in nuance from its Protestant counterpart. One can scarcely distinguish confessional identities” (p. 92). In the other “Foundation” essay, on “The Art of Preaching,” Françoise Deconinck-Brossard, who focuses on English and French preachers, observes that “Catholic and Protestant tractates differed little” (p. 127). Again, she explores broad themes — the importance of classical rhetoric, and ideas of moderation, clarity, and the plain style — and the impact of individuals, notably John Tillotson. Thomas Worcester continues the theme of the classical sermon, looking at Tillotson too, and also at John-Pierre Camus, Jacques-Bénigne Bossuet, and Louis Bourdaloue; even Voltaire praised Bossuet’s “sublime” eloquence.

Two essays stress change during the period under consideration. The first, on Pietism and revival, by Jonathan Strom, studies the influence of Philipp Jakob Spener, August Hermann Francke, Nikolas Ludwig von Zinzendorf, George Whitefield, and John Wesley, while touching on wider themes (the preaching of Moravian and Methodist women, for example). The second, by Pasi Ihalainen, shows the impact of Enlightenment religious thinking on sermons — albeit in differing ways, and to varying degrees, in different states — and the less dogmatic, more practical teaching, emphasizing reason, that resulted. Sabine Holtz also shows the importance of the practical in a fine essay on sermons and daily life — sermons that discussed work, social responsibility, *The Advantage of Stall Feeding over Pasturing*, and *The Unutterable Blessing of Growing Potatoes* (pp. 277–278). Holtz again stresses the range of sermons — domestic as well as public — and their importance for the illiterate. Preaching had to engage the hearers effectively, a theme further explored by Herman Roodenburg’s study of pulpit delivery in eighteenth-century German states, Britain, and the Netherlands. Here again we see the stress on clarity, but also emotional or enthusiastic preaching and the use of gestures (one Dutch wigmaker in 1780 advertised wigs which would remain in place however furious the preacher’s gesticulations (p. 313)!).

The book concludes with an essay by the editor, “Towards a Cultural History of the Sermon.” Using letters and diaries, it gauges hearers’ expectations from sermons: the acquisition of knowledge, emotional satisfaction, strengthened personal and social identities. It also provides pointers for further research, as does the volume as a whole. The essays repeatedly note complexities and nuances that deserve fuller consideration (how general were “general” trends?) or source problems (how adequately can preachers’ gestures be recovered?). Nonetheless, it is the amount of skilfully-compressed information and the number of themes lucidly investigated which so impress in this volume.

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JAMES H. CHARLESWORTH: *The Good and Evil Serpent: How a Universal Symbol became Christianized*. New Haven, CT, and London: Yale University Press, 2010; pp. xix + 719.

Charlesworth is introduced in the publisher’s blurb as the George L. Collard Professor of New Testament Language and Literature, and director and editor of the Princeton Dead Sea Scrolls Project, Princeton Theological Seminary. He tells us in the course of this book that he is a Methodist minister, a follower of Jungian psychology, an archaeological traveller, and a man fascinated by snakes. The subtitle of this massive compendium of words and pictures indicates the main theme: a long commentary to explain

John 3:14–15. He argues repeatedly against his fellow Christian ministers and against most biblical exegetes that the symbol of the serpent is not only pervasive throughout the ancient world but that its significance is only in a minor way negative or demonic. Sometimes in the style of Frazer's *Golden Bough* or other nineteenth-century compendia, Charlesworth throws in everything — textual résumés; descriptions of paintings and statues ancient, medieval and modern; reports of others' and his own digs in the Holy Land and elsewhere in the middle or near East; private memories of encountering snakes in this place or that — well, everything but the kitchen sink. He makes long lists of positive and negative aspects of serpent imagery, discusses them, and gives a few examples, then goes back over them, and yet again, occasionally adding some new details.

You would think this overkill would cover everything, but he nowhere mentions the Cupid and Psyche central chapters of Apuleius' *The Golden Ass*, barely mentions Moses and Aaron at Pharaoh's court showing off their magic tricks, or that Pharaoh, like all of Egypt, is personified as a crocodile, a form of serpent. Nor does he notice how often the serpentine figures wound around priestesses or goddesses could just as well be long-necked swans or geese. If he is more a Jungian than a Freudian, he takes both of these psychoanalysts only in the most superficial way, and never grasps what he occasionally glimpses of psychohistorical evidence for infantile dreams, violent abuse, neglect, and adolescent fantasies.

On the one hand, even when he does get into the very meat of the meal, with his detailed analyses of the Garden of Eden story, the raising of the brass serpent in the wilderness, or the breaking down and pulverizing of the snake forms in the Temple of Jerusalem, Charlesworth is so concerned to set up preparations for the Christian icons of the Fourth Gospel or other New Testament witness that he glosses the rhetorical tricks and midrashic wit of the Hebrew Bible. He even contradicts himself to get over the stumbling block of the old-fashioned multi-authored Pentateuch, each with their own alphabetic name, like the man who tried to break down Shakespeare by separating out putative plagiarists who used Anglo-Saxon words, Latin and Greek vocabulary, French elegance, and Elizabethan slang. He seeks seriously long narratives, life journeys, and coherent theology instead of a myriad of what-if tales, homiletic examples, snide responses to pagan classicism, and political satire; in other words, a book already doubling back and commenting on itself and trying to trip up anyone who reads too seriously and thus turns its text into an idolatrous object of worship. Be as cunning as a serpent, indeed!

This book is an important encyclopaedia of texts, images, philological, linguistic, and bibliographical information, perhaps for some time to come the definitive source of data on serpent symbols. There are, however, also major drawbacks in his discussions, in his theory, and in his presuppositions. He assumes that Jesus was an historical person and the events in his life are literally as given in the New Testament rather than propagandistic misinterpretations of midrashic and messianic fantasies. He believes that ancient and even medieval peoples were "closer to nature" than we are, although the very concept of nature as an autonomous concept is questionable if taken in a post-seventeenth-century sense and certainly has no basis in traditional Jewish traditions. More likely to be attuned to natural forces and rhythms, most archaic and ancient peoples were separated from the realities we recognize in the environment by layers and layers of demonic dreams and trance-induced embodiments of their own fear-laden personalities.

As Charlesworth himself warns: "we must be careful that we do not attribute our own ideas, our own perceptions about antiquity, to silent monuments" (p. 170). Though there

is not enough space to comment on all his misperceptions and misprisions, one must do what one can under the circumstances. "Immediate context," he asserts, "determines a text's meaning" (p. 378) whereas normative midrashic procedure argues that alternative contexts, sometimes established cumulatively in order of textual appearance, sometimes according to letter-manipulations and anagrammatic paradigms, determine how to discover or construct meanings out of vital passages. In brief, the author knows many things, but he does not always seem aware of his own blind spots or ideological distortions.

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GEORGE CHRYSSIDES, ed.: *Heaven's Gate: Postmodernity and Popular Culture in a Suicide Group*. Aldershot, UK: Ashgate, 2011; pp. xi + 215.

This edited book is a welcome addition to Ashgate's impressive New Religions series. Despite the fact that the suicide of thirty-nine Heaven's Gate members in March 1997 attracted considerable media attention, in 2011 there is still no academic monograph dedicated to the group. George Chryssides's volume contains ten chapters, of which seven have been published previously (including "'88 Update — The UFO Two and their Crew" by Marshall Herff Applewhite, better known as Do, and co-founder with Bonnie Lu Nettles of Heaven's Gate). However, the majority of these essays repay re-reading, and the new contributions extend scholarly understanding of the movement. Chryssides's own new "Approaching Heaven's Gate" opens the book, and situates the movement in the context of: the counterculture of the 1960s, and the new age that promised a better future through the dawning of the Age of Aquarius; the relationship between ufology and religion and the emergence of other UFO religions; the impact of the millennium (whenever it was believed to have happened); and, finally, the "rationale and internal coherence" (p. 13) of the Heaven's Gate worldview.

Applewhite's "'88 Update" is a fascinating insider explanation of the emergence of Heaven's Gate after the meeting of Applewhite (Bo, Do) and Nettles (Peep, Ti), and a detailed description of the theology of the movement, which focused on how human beings could achieve the "Next Level" (which is the literal Kingdom of Heaven), utilizing a combination of Christianity and alternative spiritualities. The essay also offers insights into the early stages of Heaven's Gate, when large-scale meetings were addressed by the Two, to the later phases such as the "classroom," in which a smaller group spent time "tuning their minds with their Older Member's mind" (p. 30), all the way up the chain to the Heavenly Father. This piece is followed by Robert W. Balch and David Taylor's "Seekers and Saucers: The Role of the Cultic Milieu in Joining a UGO Cult" which was published in 1977 and is one of a series of early studies Balch produced, beginning in 1976. This article situates Heaven's Gate in the cultic milieu described by Colin Campbell, and makes use of Campbell's model of the "seeker" in explaining why quite substantial numbers of people joined Bo and Peep after just four public meetings.

Mark W. Muesse's brief "Religious Studies and 'Heaven's Gate': Making the Strange Familiar and the Familiar Strange" is a mere four pages, and is followed by the new "Heaven's Gate: The Dawning of a New Religious Movement" by Patricia Goerman, a more substantial twenty pages. Goerman's intention is to apply sociological theories of formation to the group, and she concludes "by placing the death of the movement, along

with its members, in a sociological context" (p. 60). Winston Davis's "Heaven's Gate: A Study of Religious Obedience" presents an ideal-typical study of obedience and responsibility in the group, with careful analysis of the ways that Applewhite redefined "flexibility" (a term he used frequently) as obedience. Hugh B. Urban's "The Devil at Heaven's Gate: Rethinking the Study of Religion in the Age of Cyberspace" first appeared in 2000, and is in dialogue with Douglas E. Cowan's new chapter, "'A Sometimes Mysterious Place': Heaven's Gate and the Manufactured Crisis of the Internet." Urban maintains that the movement was a quintessentially computer-technology-facilitated, online religion; Cowan argues that although some members of Heaven's Gate worked in the computer industry, in 1997 the Internet was quite nascent and the group did not use it to perform online ritual or engage with it in any significant way.

Benjamin Ethan Zeller's chapter, "Scaling Heaven's Gate: Individualism and Salvation in a New Religious Movement," situates the theology and soteriology of the religion in the context of American Protestantism, where election, predestination, and grace feature, which was married to a radical dualism drawn from secular acceptance of Descartes' model. The last chapter is Chryssides' "'Come on up, and I will show thee': Heaven's Gate as a Postmodern Group" which was first published in 2005 and treats the group's worldview as broadly compatible with postmodernism. The brief "Postscript" reflects on the afterlife of a mass suicide in the popular imagination, describing how the group's house had been demolished, and offering the hope that academic study may make a seemingly inexplicable act like a mass suicide more comprehensible. The overall impression after reading this volume is that the scholars have largely succeeded in this aim. Heaven's Gate still appears strange, but the richness of the data makes that strangeness less alien, and more understandable. This volume is highly recommended to all interested in new religions.

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P. BERGER, G. DAVIE, and E. FOKAS: *Religious America, Secular Europe?: A Theme and Variations*. Aldershot, UK: Ashgate, 2008; pp. vii + 168.

This volume seeks to examine various ways Europe and the U.S.A. differ when it comes to religiosity and secularity in society. Berger, Davie, and Fokas state that America is no longer the exception, but that Europe is; that is, the rest of the world is more like the religious U.S.A. than the secular Europe, and even then, Europe's secularity is changing. Berger begins the main body of the book with a chapter on the theme of America's religiosity and Europe's secularity and briefly discusses various areas in the two societies where this theme arises, such as "church as markers of class" and "two versions of the enlightenment." Davie and Fokas follow each with two of their own chapters, looking at differing areas of religiosity and secularity; however, Davie's work seems to focus more on the differences within the different European countries, rather than Europe compared with the U.S.A.

This reviewing of Europe against the staunch secular state of France aides their overall thesis; that it is Europe that is the exceptional case, as the rest of the world is moving towards religiosity over secularity. In a recent census, Britain was revealed to have seventy per cent of its population identify as Christian, despite it being one of the two main secular countries in Europe. Where this volume fails is the extensive use of

“religion” to mean “Christianity.” This is especially apparent when discussion of the U.S.A. occurs, with statements about the Republican party being friendly toward religion, which is only true if religion is taken to mean Judeo-Christianity, and potentially only Christianity. Indeed, there is next to no mention of any other religions aside from Christianity and Islam (mostly in regard to immigration to Europe and the concept of “Eurabia”).

While different European countries are mentioned, it is only in the concluding chapter that it is really stated that Europe is not a single entity. While this may be a result of Europe being stereotyped as a relatively homogenous society, and the work does contrast various European countries with one another, it feels like “Europe” should be replaced with “France” (and sometimes “Britain”). There is also the problem that the authors only consult the old theory of secularization, the “co-existence theory,” rather than examining different types of secularization such as the “disappearance theory.”

The volume is a solid examination of religiosity and secularity in Europe and the U.S.A., giving a good history of why America approaches religion quite differently to European countries, especially France and to a lesser extent Britain. It does, however, have some failings in its execution. This book would be a suitable text for undergraduate students of studies in religion or sociology looking at the divide between Western Europe and the U.S.A. in regards to religion and society.

LAUREN BERNAUER
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S. C. AKBARI: *Idols in the East: European Representations of Islam and the Orient, 1100–1450*. London: Cornell University Press, 2009; pp. x + 326.

From the outset, Akbari’s book must be given its due praise — it is a work that highlights two decades of research and reflection upon East–West relations. Focusing on the transitional phase from the European High Middle Ages to the Late Middle Ages (1100–1450), Akbari delves into the controversial medieval constructions of Islam and the Orient. The historical undertone of Akbari’s chosen timeframe is immediately noted. Throughout the eleventh and twelfth centuries, Europe experienced advances in science, literature, and learning, in general, while boasting population increase and a steady economy. This, mind you, was partly, if not significantly, owed to the prosperity of the Orient — the territories near, middle, and far east of Christendom. Indeed, the Christian world came into direct contact with Islam in one principal way: geography. There were meeting points in Muslim Spain and Byzantium, but also through the mediation of the crusaders traveling back and forth to the holy land, Jerusalem. The role of “geography,” then, is central to Akbari’s work, as it was the particular cornerstone in the way that medieval Europeans imagined the “shape of the world” and its “centres”; and more importantly, in the way that they broadly conceived of, and defined, the Orient in opposition (p. 15).

What Akbari proposes in terms of geography, however, is a development upon Edward Said’s phrase “imaginative geography” (p. 14). Said famously incorporated this when expounding on the history and ownership of the territory in Israel and Palestine (p. 14). No less controversial is Akbari’s treatment of this evocative phrase within the context of medieval Europe. One learns that this idea becomes valuable in the way that scholars can view and categorize the historiography of medieval perceptions of geography. Calling on the geographer, David Harvey, Akbari stresses, “that maps and other

schemata must be understood as participating in a dialectical process in which apparently permanent entities . . . are constructed" (p. 14). A crucial point brought to light by Akbari concerns the "evolving body" of geographical consciousness. The reader is alerted to the fact that many medieval texts actively participated in organizing "space" — doing so across a variety of written genres, including encyclopedias, scientific writings, pilgrimage itineraries, literary texts, and especially, maps — and all of which help us to appreciate the correct status of such material "not that of a universally accepted 'truth' but rather a discourse that is continually in the process of being articulated and thus creating, as it were, its own truth" (p. 14).

The next two chapters of *Idols in the East* expand upon the perceived centres of imaginative geography as shifting further east (away from Jerusalem) toward India (p. 15, esp., 85–6). This "re-imagining" of "centres" leads into the pertinence of Akbari's third chapter, "the place of the Jews," in which the overlapping depiction of Muslims and Jews prefigure the European cliché of the Oriental body (p. 16). The Europeans had two distinct categories for the Oriental: the religious and the geographical. Religiously, the Muslim and the Jew were the same, for example, both being circumcised, but they were biologically different given their respective geographical climates (p. 16). Geographically, the Jew was less consistent than the Muslim; however, the Jews were something of a paradox both geographically and religiously — something which foreshadows the present state of Muslims as migrants in the West. The Jewish community was both located "outside and inside" the Christian community, whereas the Muslim community was clearly located "outside" and "on the outer borders of the Christian community" (p. 134). The author's chapter on the Jews makes the necessary step toward understanding "medieval constructions of the Saracen body" (p. 113). Accordingly, chapter four reveals how "medieval constructions conflated categories of ethnicity and religion within a single term that served as a marker for both: 'Saracen'" (p. 155). The Muslim was confined to the "Saracen body" as a result of their climatic or geographic destiny, which also restricted their spiritual capacity and proved their religious inferiority. Akbari notes, "spatial relationships served as a conceptual template not only for the geographical description of the parts of the world, but also for the relationship of Judaism, Christianity, and Islam to spiritual truths" (p. 199).

Akbari's brilliant portrayal of medieval Christian depictions of the "other," helps contextualize the many misconceptions of later (modern) periods. Turning to the last two chapters, we arrive at a fascinating intersection. Today, we can note Muslim perceptions of Western (and, by implication, Christian) society as excessively materialistic and lacking in spiritual piety. This imagining, however, is the reverse of the medieval reality that was conversely reflected upon the Muslim "other." Medieval Christians, in fact, accused Muslims of blatant idolatry and outright superficiality (200ff), no doubt reciprocating Muslim accusations of Christian idol worship. The opinion was well developed in the *chansons de geste*, as Akbari reminds us, that Islam was a false religion with "empty idols and a false prophet" (p. 201). There is no doubt, upon reaching the final two chapters of *Idols in the East*, as to the actual meaning conveyed through that very expression. Contrary to the self-promoted image of an iconoclast religion, the followers of Islam were seen as nothing but "polytheistic idolaters" led by a would-be prophet, Muhammad, a mere "trickster" and "deceiver" who was in league with the "Antichrist" (p. 199). The eighth-century Christian apologist, St John of Damascus, in his famous defence of the use of images in Christian worship, refuted Islam on the very grounds of idolatry. He asks the rhetorical question of Muslims, "why then do you rub yourselves against that stone at your Ka'aba, and love that stone to the point of embracing it?" (p. 204). Duly noted is Dante's brazen placing

of Muhammad in *Inferno*, along with his companion Ali (p. 2). While there are subtle shifts in the way Muslims are perceived by medieval Europeans, moving on from “Saracen” to “Turk” and “Moor,” this highlights the shift in emphasis toward bodily differences rather than religious ones (p. 19). This in itself is interesting, as today the distinction maintained is that of “Arab” and “Muslim,” still recognizing the religious and bodily difference, but acknowledging these as separate yet interchangeable realities.

It seems, in the underlay, *Idols in the East*, makes a powerful assertion about the way Islam and the East are still being presented, if not explicitly in Western politics, evidently so in Western media; and even discretely lurking in the sub-conscious of its citizens. We may have “progressed” from an “age of ignorance” to an “age of enlightenment,” as Southern proposes in *Western Views of Islam in the Middle Ages* (p. 200), but the reality is Islam is still seen as the “other,” monitored cautiously as a potential, yet also as a recognized long-term rival. The point is that Akbari’s book makes it evidently clear that “hard-wired” constructions of medieval racism are not quick to change, no matter how optimistic Southern and Daniel, author of *Islam and the West* (Akbari, 200–1), may be about the shift in European attitudes toward Islam and the Orient. The fact of the matter is that Western society remains largely ignorant of the realities of Islam and, for that matter, of the (middle) East, remaining ever entrenched within the negative stereotype encouraged by media watchdogs.

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R. E. RICHEY, K. E. ROWE, and J. M. SCHMIDT: *The Methodist Experience in America: A History*, vol. 1. Nashville: Abingdon Press, 2010; pp. iv + 758.

A text-book survey of the Christian denomination known as American Methodism actually fun to read? Who knew? These seminary-professor authors have salted their complex, multi-faceted narrative with biographical sketches and peppered it with unexpected wit. *MEA I* (space alone requires lots of abbreviation by initials, for which there are the glossary pages 555 to 564) is the narrative companion of their previously published *The Methodist Experience in America: Sourcebook*, volume 2; the reader can thus instantly connect with the originating documents (legislative and reportorial) annotated in this first volume.

The young English progenitors within the 1730s Church of England, divinity students John and Charles Wesley, were indubitably spirit-led, but also systematic record-keepers (thus method-ists). Their calling, to revivify the Protestant prayer book formality that prevailed in eighteenth-century cold stone churches, developed out of pietistic bible-study groups they called “classes” — their model of outreach. Is the contemporary strength of this international denomination and its spin-off relations — from evangelical to high-church establishment — derived from that inspirational foundation of spiritual energy? If so, where did today’s streamlined Methodist bureaucracy come from? Studying the emergence of the twenty-four denominational affiliates encompassed under the United Methodist Church umbrella (their corporate title, after 1968), one is struck by this assemblage of “little churches within a church” (p. 2). The Wesley priests were taught to value “method” by their remarkable mother, Susanna Wesley, who home schooled these youngest of her twenty children and instilled their zeal for authentic (“heart-warmed”) spiritual commitment.

The twenty-first century authors of these two yoked volumes, Schmidt, Rowe, and Richey, designed the two volumes simultaneously to encompass this church's immense organizational evolution. Both volumes follow the same periodization: 1769 to 1778, the British emigrating to establish new Anglo-European settlements on the American continent; 1777 to 1784, implanting the Methodist form of church classes established by circulating (rather than stationed) preachers; 1784 to 1792, versions of Methodism's congregational organization; 1792 to 1816, the itinerant preachers' saddlebags distributing religious literature at each stop which helped spread "scriptural holiness"; 1816 to 1850, their "national missionary outreach" influencing both ethnicity and gender (women encouraged to testify); 1860 to 1865, racially separate congregations with the north and south Methodist churches divided over slavery and differing views of authority; 1884 to 1939, all national organizations being modernized, including churches, in an industrializing society (e.g., beginning of the earliest professional organization, the American Bar Association in 1878); 1939 to 1968, congregational activism "taking on the World" in foreign missions abroad, and the civil rights movement in the U.S.A.; 1968 to 1984, merging the many associated branches under the "united" denominational name; and 1984 to 2000, confronting the contemporary issues of women's ordination and racial desegregation — "holding fast [but] pressing on."

Three major illustrations of earlier historical stages are dramatized by vivid print snapshots: 1816, Baltimore MD; 1884, Wilkes-Barre PA; and 1968, Denver CO. These illuminate Methodism's self-image, social location, and cultural importance by means of church building design (e.g., the invention of the parish hall), worship practices, and theology — all reflecting the evolving attitudes toward gender and race.

The saddest dimension in all American institutional history is the stain and stigma attached to skin color, endemic in the white Christianity brought to this "new" continent. Methodism was no more culpable in this view than other European cultures, Christian and Jewish, but racist discrimination lingered in the separated northern and southern Methodist institutions, up to and through the contemporary civil rights movement, thus this reviewer's and the authors' lament of institutional racism.

The challenges confronting any student of institutionalization are listed in the Preface under "dynamics in Methodist evolution" (pp. xvii–xviii). The authors identify: (1) a tension between the letter (rules, works, "fruits") and the spirit (personal witness, testimony); (2) creating a mechanism for centralized decision making (formally structured conferences) that still allowed experimentation and appointment (on circuits, in missions, on frontiers); (3) ordered communal Christian life (in Methodist classes) that allowed emotional expression; (4) innovations in worship practices (e.g., the "love feast") elasticizing the inherited Church of England demeanor; (5) and, always, war against sin within and against Calvinism everywhere. All these blend an evangelical catholic spirit and a highly competitive denominational triumphalism. Such a sweeping authorial assignment could have been deadly if unleavened by authorial insight and wit.

Highlighting a few Methodist names from the American cultural scroll (identified here by page numbers): 1930, An Association of Southern Women for Prevention of Lynching (ASWPL) founded by Jessie Daniel Ames (p. 34); nineteenth-century leaders Georgia Harkness (pp. 300, 421), Phoebe Palmer, originator of the 1843 holiness movement (p. 132), and Frances Willard, president of Northwest Female College ("[her] own Methodist hive," later national president of the Women's Christian Temperance Union) (p. 278); twentieth-century Rosa Parks initiating the 1955 Montgomery bus boycott, and Dorothy Height, president of the National Council of Negro Women (p. 394), plus a western educational institution actually named for a woman, Iliff

Seminary in Denver (p. 432); theological pluralism toward homosexuality and race as epitomized in San Francisco's Glide Methodist church (p. 358); the modernist view of "eucharist" (sacrament? No. Memorial? Yes) (p. 412); and Methodist figures significant in dismantling racial segregation in the American national sport, Branch Rickey and Jackie Robinson (p. 394). Who knew?

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A. I. PRIETO: *Missionary Scientists. Jesuit Science in Spanish South America, 1570–1810*. Nashville: Vanderbilt University Press, 2011; pp. x + 287.

The role of the Jesuits in the promotion of early modern science has received increasing attention of late with growing interest in the way in which they both blended science into the curriculum of their wide array of schools and universities and drew on a global network to link the early scientific movement with European expansion around the earth. By focusing on a major case-study — the Jesuits in Hispanic America — this significant work takes such discussion further by providing a well-researched analysis of the interplay between Jesuit theology and pedagogy and the indigenous cultures of the Spanish New World. In particular the work provides major insights into the thought-world of one of the most important of early Jesuit anthropologists and natural historians, José de Acosta (1539–1600), author of the remarkable *Natural and Moral History of the Indies* (1590), the continuing impact of which is evident in the fact that, as recently as 2002, it was both reissued in a new Spanish edition and published in a new English translation.

As Prieto's work shows, it was Acosta who largely laid down the scientific agenda which preoccupied Jesuit intellectual labour and pedagogical energy in the Hispanic New World in the early modern period. Like Spanish intellectuals generally, the basic question which he confronted was how the indigenous peoples of the New World could be drawn within the great drama of Christian salvation. If one assumed (as Acosta and all orthodox thinkers did) that all humankind was descended from Adam and Eve it followed that the Amerindians were of the same stock as Europeans and had a common descent. How, then, had they crossed the oceans to the New World? For Acosta such theorizing meant a departure from Aristotelian orthodoxy and even speculation about the way in which the Eurasian and American continents were connected. This emphasis on the linkage between the different parts of the globe provided a framework for his natural history with its attempt to draw the fascinatingly novel material the Jesuits encountered in the New World into the broader schemas developed in Europe. With such an approach the Jesuits, as Prieto puts it (drawing on a term coined by Mary Louise Pratt) became a "contact zone" — a beachhead providing a linkage between indigenous knowledge and the intellectual structures of Europe. The result, inevitably, was that indigenous names for plants and animals were rechristened with European terms and medical cures which had been explained in very different ways by indigenous cultures were detached from such cultural settings as they were absorbed into European discourse.

For, fundamentally, the Jesuits were necessarily engaged in a translation exercise as they sought to place data drawn from the unfamiliar New World in forms which would have meaning in the world of European intellectual theorizing and, in particular, in the context of the curriculum of their schools — institutions which, as Prieto emphasizes, provided the framework which gave their work its influence and which provided

opportunities for travel and wide cultural contact. The Jesuits also attempted cultural translation in the other direction since, thanks to the insights of Acosta and other Jesuit theorists, indigenous cultures were seen as worthy of study as a way of better formulating the Christian message in forms which had meaning to indigenous cultures. This meant getting to know indigenous forms of knowledge about nature and, in particular, indigenous forms of healing and use of local medicinal plants. Such knowledge was intertwined with indigenous religion and the power of shamans and hence, in an early modern Christian worldview, was tainted by Satan. Nonetheless, the Jesuits were confident that such useful forms of knowledge could be separated from their religiously toxic connections and made available to the wider Christian world.

The intellectual theorizing which made possible such a Jesuit enterprise in the New World forms the central core of this work. The overall approach is elaborated in the earlier chapters while the later ones focus more on key case studies of how particular Jesuit philosophers continued to put this programme into practice and elaborate it further. These later chapters, with their close focus on the explication of key texts, ask rather more of the reader than the earlier more over-arching sections though they are informed by a sympathetic reading of important but not widely known works. Where these latter sections might have gone further is in widening the focus beyond such texts to the way in which these related to the dominant scientific currents of the age particularly in the field of natural history. Overall, this is a work where attention is closely paid to the Jesuits rather than to the scientific world in which they played a part. By looking in detail, however, at the way in which this religious order, with its global connections and pedagogical importance, sought to come to terms with the indigenous knowledge of the New World Prieto's fine scholarship has enriched our understanding of an important instance of a scientific crossing of frontiers.

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